

The Mesh Grid

A sorting and search instrument for the lineage of Firing on All Cylinders. Built weighted at the apex — the top tiers get the exposition, the base gets a paragraph.

How to read the pyramid

Five tiers. The apex is narrow, expensive, and hard to earn. The base is wide, cheap to add, and cheap to lose. Most rosters are built from the base up and then mistaken for an argument. This one is built from the apex down.

Each tier has a **test**. If a name fails the test, it belongs one tier lower, no matter how much you like it.

TIER 1 • LOAD-BEARING *Remove it and the thesis changes shape.* Test: can you state the claim without this concept? If yes, not Tier 1.

TIER 2 • STRESS-TEST *Attacks a load-bearing claim from a position you must survive.* Test: does it aim at the **claim** or at the **culture around the claim**? Culture-attacks are Tier 4 wearing armor. Value is proportional to damage; a comfortable adversary is decoration.

TIER 3 • INDEPENDENT ARRIVAL *Reached the same claim down a different road.* Test: could they have gotten there without reading anyone in Tier 1? If they share a teacher, it is not independence — it is a family resemblance, and it proves less than it appears to.

TIER 4 • GROUND FOR RUNNING MACHINERY *Names and legitimizes something the book already does without knowing what it is called.* Test: is the apparatus already in motion? If you would have to build it in order to use the name, it is not this tier.

TIER 5 • DIRECTIONAL *Agrees on how things get made. Interesting on presence. Not holding weight.*

The second axis: provenance

Tier alone gives you a pile-count. Crossing tier against **where the person got their epistemics** is what makes the grid generative, because it produces cells you can see are empty. An empty cell is a search query.

- **A · Continental phenomenology & hermeneutics**
 - **B · Indic and Buddhist primary sources**
 - **C · Clinical and therapeutic**
 - **D · Empirical science** (cognitive, neuro, contemplative)
 - **E · Social theory, critique, and the sociology of method**
 - **F · Systems, design, cybernetics**
 - **G · Poets and artists**
 - **H · Practitioner-pedagogy** (facilitation, transformational education, performance)
 - **I · Analytic philosophy** (*currently near-empty across every tier — see the search map*)
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The claims the grid is sorting against

Provisional, since the thesis is still forming. That is a feature here: the grid's real diagnostic power is showing **which claims are carrying the most weight on the thinnest support**.

- **C1 · The participation law.** The instrument of knowing is not separable from what it knows. You come back changed by the emergence.
 - **C2 · Aletheia.** Truth as unconcealment. The work is removal of obstruction, not addition of content. *You already know this.*
 - **C3 · The Stance.** Gaze outward, attention resting inward. Held but not holding; available and discerning.
 - **C4 · Felt-shift verification.** Nothing counts unless the body countersigns.
 - **C5 · Compositional physics.** Primitives combine into molecules; the diagnosis contains the cure. Contraction and expansion.
 - **C6 · Anti-instrumentality.** Practice and realization are one. The peak is not the work.
 - **C7 · Selflessness by self-primacy.** You arrive at selflessness through the fullness of the I, not around it. The core experience is inalienable.
 - **C8 · The Householder Axiom.** This is livable inside an ordinary life. No renunciation required.
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TIER 1 • LOAD-BEARING

The apex. Should stay small. If this tier grows past a dozen, the thesis has stopped being a thesis and become a survey.

Seated, and correctly

Trika / pratyabhijñā — Abhinavagupta, Utpaladeva, Kṣemarāja (B) Bears C1, C2, C7, and C8 simultaneously. This is the spine, and no substitution is available: recognition that can only occur from inside the recognizing, obstruction rather than absence, fullness as the road to selflessness, and a householder tradition that already solved the renunciation problem a thousand years ago. Nothing else on the roster carries four claims.

Heidegger (A) Bears C2, partly C1. The central verb is his. Worth stating plainly: it is *inherited*, not yet earned — see Sheehan in Tier 2, who makes that inheritance the problem.

Gendlin (A/C — *trained in both, which matters*) Bears C4 outright and alone. **This is the structural fact the whole grid keeps returning to.** The verification standard for the entire edifice rests on one name, and that name is currently filed in the container-maker room. Gendlin is not a container-maker. He is the floor under every claim the book makes about whether something worked. Promote, and then defend — see the C4 hole in Tier 2.

Probably misfiled — candidates for promotion

Christopher Alexander (F) Currently directional. But *structure-preserving transformation* is not a nice idea about buildings — it is the book's edit-ethic and possibly its compositional physics (C5). Centers strengthening centers is the molecular logic in another medium. If the book's method is "change without destroying what is alive," Alexander is load-bearing to the method even if not to the thesis. **Method-bearing is its own tier-1 species and the grid should say so.**

Nishitani (A/B — *the hyphen is the point*) Cannot be sorted from here, which is itself the finding. If nihility is a station the current physics cannot represent — if the Floor's *absence* is a real condition distinct from contraction — then he is Tier 1 and forces a structural revision. If it turns out to be a variant of Loy's lack, he is Tier 2. **The only way to know is to read him and let it push.** Flagged as the highest-variance name in the whole set.

The Tier 1 discipline

Every claim above should be able to name its bearer. Run this once: for C1 through C8, who holds it? If a claim has no Tier 1 name, either it is not load-bearing or it is being carried by the prose. The second is the dangerous case, and the prose is good enough to hide it.

TIER 2 · STRESS-TEST

The tier that decides whether the book is an argument or an aesthetic. Weight it heavily. A thesis with no adversaries is a mood.

Sorted by **which claim they aim at**, because that is the only sort that reveals holes.

Against C2 (aletheia) — well defended, three-sided

Michel Henry (A) — the clearing is derivative. Auto-affection, immanence, Life feeling itself with no distance; *ontological monism* as the name for Heidegger's error. Attacks the central image from below.

Nishitani (A/B) — the clearing stands in nihility, not emptiness. Attacks from beneath.

Thomas Sheehan (A) — **and this is the sharpest of the three, which is easy to miss because he is a scholar rather than a system-builder.** Sheehan's late project argues that the mystical-numinous reading of *Lichtung* and *aletheia* is a mistranslation — that Heidegger meant the a priori openness that makes meaning possible, not a luminous event of disclosure. If Sheehan is right, the book's central verb is built on a misreading that a generation of secondary literature installed. That is not an attack on the claim; it is an attack on the **provenance** of the claim, which is worse and harder to answer. He was on the eleven-name list. He should not be treated as an optional scholarly footnote.

Note the concentration: all three are family A. See the search map.

Against C4 (felt-shift) — the largest hole in the project

Currently: nobody.

The claim doing the most work has the least defense. The candidates, all missing:

Nisbett & Wilson (1977) (D) — *Telling More Than We Can Know*. People confabulate reports of their own mental processes and lack privileged access to them. This is the canonical empirical strike, and it aims exactly where the book is thinnest.

Eric Schwitzgebel (D/I) — *Perplexities of Consciousness*. Introspection is unreliable **even about current experience**, not merely about causes. Precise, unmalicious, devastating.

Steven Katz (E) — constructivism: the felt shift is trained by the tradition that produces it, so its countersignature confirms the training, not the truth. Already on the eleven-name list. Belongs here, seated against C4 specifically — not left floating as a general skeptic.

Until this cell is populated, "the body countersigns" is an assertion wearing the costume of a standard.

Against C1 (the participation law) — empty

Nothing on the roster attacks the central claim. That is a strange thing to be true of a central claim.

The attack exists and is old: **participation is contamination with better branding**. The entire apparatus of blinding, randomization, and pre-registration was built because the knower inside the system distorts it. Candidates: the replication-reform literature (*D*); Popper and the unfalsifiability problem (*I*); Gellner's *The Psychoanalytic Movement* (*E*) on systems that metabolize every objection as further evidence.

That last one deserves attention. A book that says *the instrument is inside the object* has built a structure in which disagreement can always be re-read as the disagreeer's obstruction. Gellner is the diagnosis of exactly that move. It is the single most useful uncomfortable name available.

Against C3 (the Stance) — empty

The available attack: **gaze outward, attention inward is dissociation with good branding**. The depersonalization and derealization literature (*D/C*) describes the observing self as a symptom, not an attainment. And **Willoughby Britton's** adverse-effects research (*D*) documents deadening, flattened affect, and detachment as outcomes of contemplative practice.

For a book that opens reconsolidation windows and writes an Afterglow law, the harm literature is not optional. Its absence is currently the book's most defensible criticism.

Against C5 (compositional physics)

Richard Biernacki (*E*) — you built the instrument that finds it, and now you find it everywhere. Aimed at *Burnout = Obligation – Sanctuary* and every molecule after it.

The diagnostic-reification critique (*D/E*) — the DSM's history, and the RDoC turn away from it, is the fully documented case study of a category scheme that became real by being used. Available and unused.

Paul Meehl (*D/I*) — on theories in soft psychology that are unfalsifiable because everything correlates with everything. The formal version of Biernacki's charge.

Against C6, C7, C8 — reasonably held

C6: **Han** (*E*), and the internal contradiction — if practice is not for anything, why does the book promise transformation? C7: **Nāgārjuna's snake-warning** (*B*), **Loy** (*B/A*), **Nishitani** (*A/B*), **Weil** (*A/G*). C8: **Weil** again, named already as its worthiest adversary. Correctly seated.

The Tier 2 discipline

An adversary is only Tier 2 if the book could lose. Run each name against this: *what specifically breaks if they are right?* If the answer is “we would phrase it differently,” demote to Tier 4.

TIER 3 · INDEPENDENT ARRIVAL

Evidence rather than support. Weighted third because it is where the thesis stops being a lineage and starts being a finding — but only if the independence is real.

The independence test is failing right now. Nishitani studied under Heidegger in Freiburg. Corbin translated him into French in 1938. Henry built his system against him. Three of the four names currently under consideration are in conversation with the same German. That is a family quarrel, not a convergence.

The strong candidates, by family

Michael Polanyi ($D \rightarrow I$) — **the most valuable missing name in the project.** A physical chemist who arrived at *indwelling* — his word — tacit knowing, and the personal participation of the knower, from inside the philosophy of science with no phenomenological debt. *We can know more than we can tell.* The subsidiary-to-focal structure is the Stance described by someone who came at it through crystallography. If C1 has one non-continental witness, it should be him.

Heinz von Foerster (F) — second-order cybernetics. The observer inside the observed system; objectivity as the delusion that observations can be made without an observer. Arrived at C1 from engineering.

Harold Garfinkel (E) — ethnomethodology, 1967. Social facts are produced in the doing; accounts are constitutive rather than descriptive; the breaching experiments are C1 as laboratory demonstration.

Donald Schön (H/E) — *The Reflective Practitioner*. Knowing-in-action. And his image — the swampy lowlands where the problems that matter live, versus the high hard ground of technical rationality — is the de-management pass, drawn in 1983 by a management theorist.

Wittgenstein (I) — *Philosophical Investigations* §129: the aspects of things most important to us are hidden by their simplicity and familiarity; one cannot notice something because it is always before one's eyes. **That is the WALL/DOOR/FLOOR veto reason, stated in 1953 with no Heidegger under it.** *Nothing hides like the always-there* has an independent arrival

and the book does not know it yet. This is the single cleanest found correspondence in the grid.

Deci & Ryan (D) — self-determination theory and the undermining effect: instrumentalizing an intrinsically motivated activity degrades it. C6 with data.

Keith Johnstone (H) — *Impro*. Status, the offer, "be average." Presence under witness, arrived at through theatre training with no philosophy attached. Given the theatre in your own background, this is a homecoming rather than an import.

Avodah be-gashmiyut (non-Indic contemplative) — worship through corporeality, Hasidic. The Householder Axiom arrived at independently, in another hemisphere, under another God. Beside it: Brother Lawrence's kitchen, and Ignatian contemplation in action. C8 currently has no independent arrival at all; these are it.

Ubuntu personhood — Menkiti, Ramose (non-Western, non-Indic) — the person constituted *through* relation. Not self-primacy, not no-self, a third thing. Relevant to C7's fork specifically, and the fork currently has only two poles because only two traditions are in the room.

TIER 4 • GROUND FOR RUNNING MACHINERY

Brief, because the tier is diagnostic rather than argumentative.

Corbin (A) — the imaginal apparatus is already running: the tuning fork, the gold thread, the orchard, the threshold-gate. *Mundus imaginalis* and *ta'wīl* name what the book already does. The correspondence with **paśyantī** is found, not constructed, and it is the strongest single connection in the recent set. Seat him with Katz in the room, and know Wasserstrom's charge — that the Eranos circle lifted esotericism clean out of its legal and communal context — is structurally the same charge available against the book's use of Trika.

Benjamin, Winnicott (C) — the Third and holding. Machinery in motion, correctly grounded.

McGilchrist (D/A) — patrons the Loops. Structural, therefore arguably misfiled downward.

Illich (E) — the reading contract's historian. Lectio versus extraction.

TIER 5 • DIRECTIONAL

The base. Roughly thirty names who agree on how things get made and have something

worth hearing about presence and the Stance, without holding weight. Meadows, Akomolafe, Whyte, O'Donohue, Oliver, Berry, brown, Parker, Scharmer, Palmer, Kimmerer, Oxman, Matuschak, Appleton, Brander, Hudson, Kwan, Le Guin, Carse, Eno.

This tier is not a problem and does not need pruning. It is the book's *company* — the sense that the work belongs to a living conversation rather than arriving from nowhere. Its only failure mode is being mistaken for the argument. The grid exists partly so that mistake stops being available.

THE SEARCH MAP

The empty cells, ranked by what filling them would buy.

1 • Tier 2 against C4. The verification standard is undefended. Nisbett & Wilson, Schwitzgebel, Katz. *Highest priority in the entire grid.* Until this is populated, the felt shift is the book's load-bearing wall with no inspection stamp.

2 • Tier 2 against C1. The central claim has no adversary. Gellner, Popper, the replication reformers. Specifically hunt the argument that participation-epistemics immunize themselves against disagreement.

3 • Tier 3 from families D, F, I. The countersignature problem. Polanyi first, then von Foerster, Garfinkel, Wittgenstein. This is what converts the participation law from a lineage position into a finding.

4 • Tier 2 against C3. The dissociation reading of the Stance, plus Britton's harm data. Currently the most defensible criticism of the book and the easiest to fix.

5 • Tier 3 for C8 from outside the Indic world. Hasidic corporeality, Ignatian action, Layman Pang. The Householder Axiom is a load-bearing claim with zero independent witnesses.

6 • A third pole for the C7 fork. Ubuntu. The fork has two poles because the room has two traditions.

The family-level read

Three provenance families are near-empty across every tier: **analytic philosophy (I)**, **cybernetics (F)**, and **improvisation and performance pedagogy (H)**. Those are exactly where the strongest missing arrivals live — Wittgenstein, von Foerster, Johnstone. That is not a coincidence. It is the shape of the reading that has happened so far, and the grid's most useful output is making that shape visible from outside.

How to run this

Do not sort all thirty. The result is known: they are Tier 5, you said so yourself, and confirming a premise is not research.

Run instead the **one question, thirty times**: *does the thesis move if this one leaves?* Expect two or three yeses. Gendlin is one. Alexander is likely another. Those are the misfiled load-bearers, and finding them is worth the whole pass.

Then use the empty cells as reading queue, in the order above.

The apex should stay narrow. Every promotion to Tier 1 costs something — a claim that everything supports is a claim that nothing tests.

ADDENDUM · THE THREADS, SORTED

Names recovered from the coaches thread, the therapeutic-lineages thread, the seed's chapter lineages, and the Tana/ontology threads. Sorted by the same tests. Two of these force a change to the grid itself.

TIER 0 · THE PRECEDENT BENCH

A new tier, and it sits outside the pyramid rather than on top of it.

These names are not sorted by what they carry. They are sorted by **what happened to them when they tried this** — a grand synthesis across contemplative and empirical traditions, aimed at practitioners, delivered as a usable system. Their value is not agreement or opposition. It is *case history*.

The grid needed this tier because Wilber would not sit anywhere else without distortion.

Ken Wilber — the nearest prior attempt, named as such in your own words: *like The Theory of Everything by Wilber in its systematization*. His failure modes are unusually well documented, which makes him the most instructive name on this bench:

- **The unfalsifiability charge.** Everything fits inside AQAL, therefore nothing tests it. This is Gellner's objection landing on your nearest neighbor rather than on you — which means you can watch what it did to him.

- **The scholarship critiques.** Frank Visser's *Integral World*, Jeff Meyerhoff's *Bald Ambition*: sources cited toward a conclusion the system already held.
- **The 2006 "Wyatt Earp" episode**, in which he answered his critics with contempt. It cost him more than any critique did. A synthesis that cannot metabolize disagreement declares something about the synthesis.
- **The color hierarchy that became a status ladder.** People identifying as *teal*. A developmental map handed to practitioners turns into a ranking of persons unless something in the design actively prevents it.

That last one is the live question for you and it is not rhetorical. The metabolic arc — Nascent → Privated → Full → Flourishing → Composting — is exactly the kind of scheme that becomes "*I'm mostly Flourishing, he's still Privated.*" **What in the design prevents it?** If the answer is "the tone," the answer is not sufficient. Wilber had good tone for twenty years.

Douglas Hofstadter, Gödel, Escher, Bach — also named by you, and the instructive contrast. GEB succeeded at the breadth you want, and it succeeded partly by **refusing to deliver a usable framework**. It performs its insight and never hands you the tool. Your book hands over twelve primitives and a kata. That is a different bargain with the reader, and the precedent does not transfer.

Gurdjieff / Ouspensky — the Fourth Way. The nearest structural ancestor to a *mythic operating system for the modern soul*: total self-observation, a vocabulary, a school. Also the clearest record of how such a thing acquires authority dynamics its founder did not intend.

John Vervaeke — precedent in progress, already in your own stated cloaking. Watchable in real time.

Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi — the other road: operationalize a single construct, get it into the empirical literature, and pay a different price when *flow* becomes a productivity term. The cost of being adopted rather than the cost of being dismissed.

WILBER, PROPERLY SEATED

Your instinct was right — holonic categorization is not remotely all of it. He is already load-bearing in at least two places without being credited, and he supplies one guardrail the architecture currently lacks entirely.

1 • The Wilber–Combs lattice → TIER 1, for the state/trait throughline. States and structures are independent axes. Anyone at any stage can have any state — but the state is

interpreted according to the structure. The book already declares the ahwal/maqamat distinction as the thing protecting it from spiritual bypass. That is the distinction. This is the **engine**. It answers the question the entire psychedelic section must answer: *why do people have enormous experiences and not change?* Because the state was interpreted by an unchanged structure. Nothing else on the roster answers that with a mechanism.

2 · Lines of development → the title's own logic. *Firing on all cylinders* presupposes multiple semi-independent lines that can develop at different rates — world-class in the cognitive line, infantile in the interpersonal one. That presupposition is the book's diagnostic premise, and it is a Wilber claim currently wearing a car metaphor.

3 · The pre/trans fallacy → TIER 2, against C2 and C7. And this is a hole the size of a chapter. Pre-rational and trans-rational both look non-rational from outside and are routinely confused. For a book that walks readers toward the collapse of the interface, the gatekeeper fighting the clearing, and the deliberate destabilization at the peak — this is the diagnostic that separates breakthrough from breakdown, and it is unnamed anywhere in the architecture. Without it, the book has no principled way to tell a reader in dissolution from a reader in regression. Neither does the reader.

4 · AQAL's lower-right quadrant → the standing critique of the coaching field. The July analysis found the shared blind spot of the American transformation canon: *the radical interiority of cause*. Wilber's four quadrants is precisely the structural objection — interior/exterior crossed with individual/collective, and the Lower-Right (systems, institutions, material conditions) is the quadrant every coach skips. **He is already the critique you reached independently.** Use him that way rather than as a categorizer, and he stops being furniture.

5 · Transcend and include → your native edit-verb. Koestler's holon by way of Wilber, and you use it as an *instruction* — "transcend and include v2." It is already the compositional logic of primitives → molecules → forms, and of the Haecceity Graph's layered ontology. An unattributed operating verb is worth attributing, if only so you can see what it commits you to.

Net: one Tier 1 seat, one Tier 2 seat aimed at a genuine hole, one Tier 4 ground, and a Tier 0 case history. He was never a Tier 5 name.

THE COACHES — A BLOC, NOT ELEVEN NAMES

Crone, Katie, Singer, Hudson, Hendricks, the Conscious Leadership Group, Colonna, Robbins, Wineland, Deida, Hübl.

Individually most of them sort Tier 5. **As a bloc they are Tier 2, and they aim at C5.**

The five theories of where suffering lives — believed thought, resisted feeling, disempowered state, disowned complicity, closed body — are **five rival theories to the compositional physics**. Each is a complete competing account. Until now the C5 adversary cell held only Biernacki, who attacks the *method*. These attack the *content*: they say suffering has one location, and the molecular scheme says it has a combinatorial one. The book has to either subsume them or beat them, and right now it does neither out loud.

Two members break out of the bloc:

Tony Robbins → TIER 2, seriously. The voluntarist pole, and nearly alone in it. He is the only one who says *direct* where everyone else says *allow*. Your book resolves surrender-versus-will through the **middle voice** — but a resolution is only earned if the opposing pole was at full strength. Robbins at full strength is the claim that the not-doing is the disease. Treat him as a punchline and the middle voice becomes a mood rather than a position.

Thomas Hübl → TIER 3, independent arrival at C5's logic. *What was never metabolized lives on as absence*. That is **privation** — arrived at through collective and ancestral trauma work, with no Trika under it. Your own diagnostic sentence is *this is Obligation privated of Sanctuary*. Same shape, different road, no shared teacher. This is a genuine found correspondence and it is the strongest thing the coaches thread contributes.

And the bloc's shared blind spot is a Tier 1 question for you, not for them. *The radical interiority of cause* — the problem always relocated inside the person, where there is leverage. Does the book inherit it? *Burnout = Obligation – Sanctuary* locates a burnout in a personal configuration. The counterweights are already on your bench and currently unused for this purpose: Han (auto-exploitation is structural), Illich, Rieff, Adorno on material conditions going unexamined. This is a live seam and it is where a serious reader will press first.

OTHER NAMES RECOVERED, SORTED

Martin Buber (*A / Jewish philosophy*) — **probable Tier 1, currently seated as chapter lineage**. I–Thou is the origin of the entire relational-presence vocabulary the book runs on, and Buber arrived there independently of Heidegger and later explicitly against him. If C3 and the relational molecules have a philosophical bearer, it is him, not Benjamin — Benjamin is the clinic, Buber is the ontology.

al-Qushayri / the Sufi ahwal–maqamat distinction (*non-Indic contemplative*) — **Tier 3 for the state/trait claim**, arrived at a millennium before Wilber and entirely independently.

States descend as gifts; stations are earned by the sweat of the brow. Two independent witnesses to the same structure is materially stronger than one, and this also partly fills the C8 gap flagged in the main search map.

Byron Katie (*H*) — Tier 4. Ground for the story-dissolution machinery; the load-bearing beam under Crone.

Conscious Leadership Group; Jerry Colonna (*H*) — Tier 4/5. *Complicit in the conditions I say I don't want* is a usable primitive-adjacent formulation and is closest to your actual working life.

Otto Scharmer (*F/H*) — Tier 4. Presencing, the open will ahead of the plan. Machinery-adjacent rather than directional; sits with the Loops.

Wineland, Deida (*H*) — Tier 5, with one caveat: the embodied-devotional camp is the only one of the five that locates suffering in a *withheld gift* rather than a misperception. That is the closest thing in the coaching field to the book's generosity register, and it deserves one honest look before demotion.

Michael Singer, Gay Hendricks, Peter Crone (*H*) — Tier 5.

REVISED SEARCH MAP • ADDITIONS

7 • The pre/trans guardrail. The book cannot currently distinguish dissolution from regression, and neither can its reader. Wilber names it; the clinical literature on spiritual emergency (Grof) and Britton's adverse-effects data populate it. *Priority: high, and rising with every peak-state passage.*

8 • The interiority-of-cause audit. Run every molecule against the question: *does this relocate a structural condition inside a person?* The counterweights are already seated. The audit is not.

9 • Precedent-bench post-mortems. Specifically: what design feature, if any, prevents a developmental scheme from becoming a status ladder among the people who adopt it? No one on this bench solved it. That may be the most valuable unanswered question in the grid.